

Kunj Thakkar

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EDUCATION

- IIIT Vadodara** Gujarat, India
Bachelor of Technology - Computer Science and Engineering; CGPA: 8.25 2022 - May 2026

SKILLS SUMMARY

- SIEM / Monitoring:** Wazuh, Splunk, ELK Stack (Elasticsearch, Logstash, Kibana)
- Networking:** TCP/IP fundamentals, packet analysis with Wireshark and tshark
- Security Tools:** Burp Suite, Caido, Nmap, Metasploit
- Scripting:** Python, Bash
- OSINT / Threat Intel:** Phone/email intelligence gathering, Telegram group monitoring, dark web intel collection
- Platforms:** Linux (Arch, Ubuntu Server), Windows, Git
- Training:** TryHackMe SAL1 path (completed), HackTheBox Web Pentesting path (completed), TryHackMe AI Security (Completed)

EXPERIENCE

- [REDACTED FOR CONFIDENTIALITY]** Gujarat, India
OSINT Analyst Feb 2025 - Jan 2026
 - Intelligence Gathering:** Conducted OSINT investigations
 - Confidentiality:** Work was conducted under strict confidentiality; details not publicly disclosable.
- IIIT Vadodara** Gujarat, India
Research Intern Feb 2026 - May 2026
 - Non-Uniformity Correction Research:** Evaluated 6-8 algorithms quantitatively for non-uniformity correction in infrared imaging using NUC thermal sensor data.
 - Quantitative Analysis:** Benchmarked algorithm performance to identify optimal correction methods for sensor noise reduction.
- Independent Security Researcher** Remote
Bug Bounty Hunter May 2026 - Present
 - Vulnerability Research:** Actively hunting on public bug bounty programs; performed recon, JavaScript security analysis, and vulnerability triage across multiple targets.

PROJECTS

- Home SOC Lab (SIEM, Threat Detection, Log Monitoring):** Self-built detection lab with Wazuh deployed on an Ubuntu server, ingesting Sysmon logs and file integrity monitoring alerts from a connected Windows endpoint and a second Ubuntu server. Tech: Wazuh, Ubuntu Server, Sysmon, FIM (2026)
- tamper (Bug Bounty Tooling, Go, HTTP/2):** Single-binary interactive CLI (`go install`) that walks testers through 31 host-header injection and body-manipulation payloads against account-update flows (email/password/username/mobile change), auto-detecting HTTP/1.1 and HTTP/2 (incl. Burp pseudo-headers) and auto-generating a markdown report with pass/fail summary. Tech: Go. github.com/cipherKT/tamper (2026)
- tdo (Side Project, Systems Programming):** TUI-based task manager built in Rust with SQLite persistence and Waybar status bar integration for Arch/Omarchy Linux. Tech: Rust, SQLite

ACHIEVEMENTS

- Winner – BRC Competition, IIIT Vadodara:
Coded a highly optimized Python script to process billions of rows of data using memory-mapped files and multiprocessing, achieving first place among institute participants. The solution efficiently computed per-city statistics (min/mean/max) while ensuring minimal memory usage.

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

- TechHunt Organizer – IIIT Vadodara** Gujarat, India
CTF + Treasure Hunt Event — Cerebro Tech Fest Jan 2024, Dec 2024
 - Independently organized and hosted the first edition of TechHunt; handled end-to-end setup, question design, and infrastructure with minimal assistance.
 - Led a team of 3 in the second edition; introduced a new harmonic mean-based scoring mechanism for balanced evaluation.
 - The event recorded the highest participation in the institute's tech fest history.
- HackIIITV 2025 – Judge, Round 1** Gujarat, India
Institute Hackathon Jan 2025
 - Evaluated project submissions during the initial round of the official college hackathon.